

Saber Ayatollahi, CFA, MSc

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SUMMARY

Risk governance and model-oversight professional with ~7 years of experience in independent review, issue escalation, and controls remediation, pursuing the Head of the Canada Risk Office mandate at Capital One Canada. Holds delegated sign-off authority over institutional analytics (\$5-25bn per engagement) within a formal model governance framework, escalates and remediates control gaps, and closed a governance audit finding through a controlled Python migration. Cross-functional coordination experience spans finance, risk, IT, and actuarial stakeholders on regulatory transformation programs (IFRS 17/IFRS 9). CFA charterholder; dual MSc.

CORE SKILLS

Risk Governance & Control Frameworks • Model Risk Management & Independent Challenge • Issue Identification, Escalation & Remediation • Methodology, Documentation & Benchmarking Standards • Process Controls & Auditability • Governance Audit Remediation • Regulatory Change Implementation (IFRS 17 / IFRS 9) • Stress Testing & Scenario Analysis • Risk Metrics & Executive Reporting • Cross-Functional Stakeholder Coordination • Process Management, Improvement & Python Automation of Manual Workflows

EXPERIENCE

Moody's Analytics

Asst. Director, Modelling Services

Toronto, May 2023 - Present

Risk Governance, Oversight & Independent Challenge

- Holds delegated sign-off authority on valuation, sensitivity, and ALM outputs for multi-asset institutional portfolios of \$5-25bn per engagement (~\$50bn+ cumulative), applying independent review before production release.
- Serves on the model governance committee, contributing to methodology review, documentation and benchmarking standards, and model-performance assessment for client-delivered analytics.
- Operates within a formal model governance framework, validating assumptions and economic defensibility to documentation standards consistent with SR 11-7 and OSFI E-23 expectations.

Issue Escalation, Remediation & Control Closure

- Escalates outputs lacking mathematical or economic defensibility and serves as escalation point for client-critical analytical issues, interfacing with clients' Heads of Risk and investment stakeholders.
- Held a client release for 48 hours after portfolio sensitivities passed internal checks but failed economic review, traced the defect to a curve-calibration edge case, escalated to product owners and the client's Head of Risk, and embedded the fix in permanent validation tests.
- Re-engineered a spreadsheet-driven valuation workflow into a logged, version-controlled Python pipeline, running two shadow-mode reconciliation cycles before cutover and closing the open governance audit item.

Risk Metrics, Reporting & Process Improvement

- Prepares analytical summaries for senior stakeholders on interest-rate exposure, scenario impacts, and balance-sheet sensitivities, translating quantitative output into committee-ready narratives.
- Led design of an enterprise multi-asset cash flow projection engine supporting base, stress, and reverse-stress scenarios, with time-bucketed liquidity metrics from T+1 through multi-year horizons.
- Built agentic AI development workflows (Claude Code, Cursor IDE) automating code generation, validation scaffolding, and anomaly detection, reducing development cycle time an estimated 30-40% on comparable modules.

Client Service Specialist

Toronto, May 2022 - May 2023

- Led onboarding and implementation for U.S. and Canadian pension funds, asset managers, and consulting firms migrating to the PFaroe DB and PFaroe PM analytics platforms; validated model outputs post-deployment.

- Acted as technical liaison between client investment teams and product owners, scoping requirements into development requests and completing migration of all assigned accounts off the legacy Calypso platform.

Ernst & Young (EY)

Senior Consultant, IFRS & Financial Risk Transformation

Toronto, Sep 2021 - Apr 2022

- Delivered IFRS 17 and IFRS 9 transformation projects for Canadian and international insurance clients, aligning new regulatory requirements with system implementation and reporting frameworks.
- Advised actuarial, IT, finance, and program management functions on IFRS 17 and IFRS 9 adoption; contributed to governance documentation and regulatory compliance readiness processes for financial institutions.
- Coordinated across actuarial, finance, IT, risk, and PM teams on milestone delivery and implementation materials.

Ortec Finance Canada

Consultant, Asset-Liability Management & Risk

Toronto, Feb 2019 - Sep 2021

- Delivered ALM studies for Canadian and international pension funds and institutional investors, analyzing funding ratios, duration mismatch, and long-term balance-sheet risk exposures.
- Designed stochastic risk-management frameworks tailored to client mandates and built economic scenario generators used to stress test funding volatility and interest-rate exposure under base and stressed environments.
- Led onboarding and the ALM study for a three-plan university pension merger on a three-person team, developing and validating the model capturing all funding policy dynamics.
- Presented study findings and allocation recommendations to investment committees at Canadian pension fund clients on-site.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

- Chartered Financial Analyst (CFA) - CFA Institute, 2024
- MSc, Financial Modelling - Western University, 2018
- MSc, Chemical Engineering (Full Scholarship) - Western University, 2016